Practical 2 : Sending Secret Message Using CMD & Notepad

Aim

To hide a secret message inside an image file using Command Prompt without using any programming language.

Theory

Steganography is a technique of hiding secret data inside another file such as an image, audio, or video.

In this method:

- We combine an **image file** and a **text file**
- The message is hidden inside the image file
- The image appears normal but contains hidden data

This method is based on file concatenation (joining files).

Requirements

- Command Prompt (CMD)
- Notepad
- Any image file (e.g., `image.jpg`)

Files Used

1. **Image File:** `image.jpg`
2. **Text File:** `secret.txt`

Step-by-Step Procedure

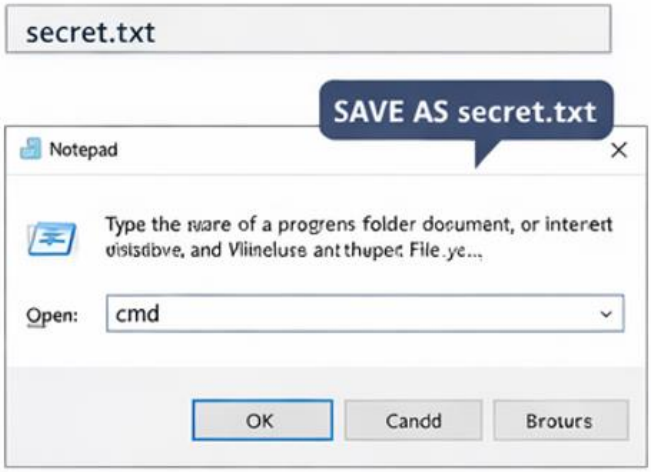
Step 1: Create Secret Message File

1. Open Notepad
2. Type your secret message

Example:

```
This is a secret message
```

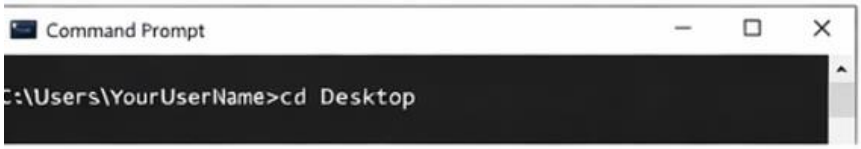
3. Save file as: `secret.txt`



Step 2: Keep Image Ready

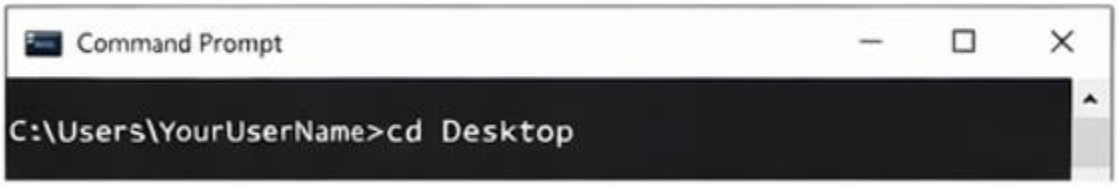
Take any image and save it as: `image.jpg`

Sample image (image.jpg)



Step 3: Open Command Prompt

- Press Win + R and typ e CMD to open command prompt and Press Enter



Step 4: Go to Folder Location

Example: `cd Desktop`

(Go to the folder where both files are saved)

Step 5: Merge Image and Text File

Type this command:

```
copy /b image.jpg + secret.txt output.jpg
```

Explanation

- `/b` → Binary mode
- `+` → Combines files
- `output.jpg` → Final image with hidden message

Output

After running command:

```
1 file(s) copied.
```

A new file will be created:

```
output.jpg
```

Result Observation

- `output.jpg` looks exactly like original image
- But it contains hidden message

The output image appears unchanged but secretly contains the embedded message.

Extracting the Hidden Message

Using Notepad

1. Right-click `output.jpg`
2. Open with Notepad

□ Scroll to bottom
□ You will see:

```
This is a secret message
```